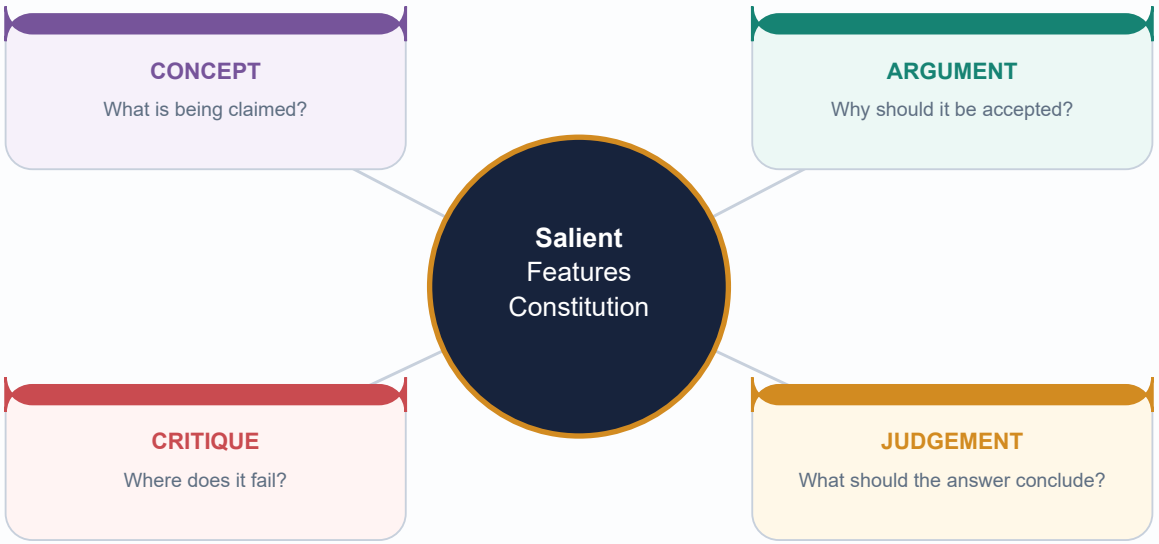
UPSC INDIAN POLITY

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains
Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth
Sources: Salient-Features.md + 03_Salient-Features.md
Learning cards: 62



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Basic (foundation) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant (Ch. 3)
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge · □ = current affairs	

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant (Ch. 3)

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge · □ = current affairs

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge · □ = current affairs

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Detail
Original (1949)	□ Preamble + **395 Articles** + 22 Parts + **8 Schedules**
Book's 2019 snapshot	□ **~470 Articles** + 25 Parts + **12 Schedules**; exact article totals vary with counting of inserted/omitted provisions, so Parts/Schedules are safer
Biggest source	□ **GoI Act 1935**
Nickname of 42nd Amdt	□ **"Mini-Constitution"**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 The world's **lengthiest written constitution**, borrowed from many countries but adapted to India. It is **federal with a unitary bias**, **parliamentary**, **secular**, and has an **integrated, independent judiciary**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The world's **lengthiest written constitution**, borrowed from many countries but adapted to India. It is **federal with a unitary bias**, **parliamentary**, **secular**, and has an **integrated, independent judiciary**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Key features (quick list) · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

#	Feature
1	Lengthiest written constitution
2	Drawn from various sources
3	Blend of rigidity & flexibility
4	**Federal with unitary bias** ("Union of States", Art 1)
5	Parliamentary government (Westminster)
6	Parliamentary sovereignty + judicial supremacy
7	Integrated & independent judiciary
8–10	FR, DPSP, Fundamental Duties

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Key features (quick list)

HIGH

Foundation · Key features (quick list) · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

#	Feature
11	□ Secular state
12	□ Universal adult franchise (18 yrs)
13	□ Single citizenship
14	□ Independent bodies (EC, CAG, UPSC)
15	□ Emergency provisions
16	□ Three-tier government (73rd/74th Amdt)
17	□ Co-operative societies (97th Amdt)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Key features (quick list)

HIGH

Foundation · Sources — the essentials · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Source	Key borrowing
□ GoI Act 1935	Federal scheme, Governor, emergency, PSCs
□ British	Parliamentary govt, rule of law, single citizenship, writs
□ USA	Fundamental Rights, judicial review, VP post
□ Ireland	DPSP, Rajya Sabha nomination, President's election
□ Canada	Strong-Centre federation, residuary powers
□ Australia	Concurrent List, joint sitting
□ USSR	Fundamental Duties, justice ideals
□ France	Republic, liberty-equality-fraternity

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Sources — the essentials

HIGH

Foundation · Sources — the essentials · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Source	Key borrowing
□ South Africa	Amendment procedure
□ Japan	Procedure established by law

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Sources — the essentials

HIGH

Foundation · Sources — the essentials

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Mnemonic traps: **Concurrent List = Australia · DPSP = Ireland · FD = USSR ·**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Amendment = South Africa · Procedure established by law = Japan**.

MEMORY HOOK

Mnemonic traps: Concurrent List = Australia · DPSP = Ireland · FD = USSR ·

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Sources — the essentials

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Art 1 = **"Union of States"** (word "Federation" never used).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS): RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

V

Dimension 1 □ Art 1 = "Union of States" (word "Federation" never used).	**Dimension 2** □ India = federal with unitary bias ("quasi-federal" — K.C. Wheare).
Dimension 3 □ Secular/Socialist added to Preamble by 42nd Amdt, 1976.	**Dimension 4** □ Voting age 21 → 18 by 61st Amdt, 1988.

STATIC THEORY

- □ India = **federal with unitary bias** ("quasi-federal" — K.C. Wheare).
- □ **Secular/Socialist** added to Preamble by **42nd Amdt, 1976**.
- □ Voting age **21** → **18** by **61st Amdt, 1988**.
- □ **73rd & 74th Amdts (1992)** = third-tier (panchayats/municipalities).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 1 = **"Union of States"** (word "Federation" never used).

2. India = **federal with unitary bias** ("quasi-federal" — K.C. Wheare).

3. Secular/Socialist added to Preamble by **42nd Amdt, 1976**.

4. Voting age **21** → **18** by **61st Amdt, 1988**.

5. 73rd & 74th Amdts (1992) = third-tier (panchayats/municipalities).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ J&K operated under its own Constitution within Article 370's asymmetrical arrangement until 2019. In December 2023 the Supreme Court upheld the application of the whole Constitution through the 2019 measures, treated Article 370 as temporary and recorded the Union's assurance on restoration of statehood. No official restoration notification was located in the sources checked on **28 August 2026**. □□ All the features in detail, the sources table, the criticism, the traps and the Mains angles are held **in this file**. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/03_Salient-Features.md — not required for any mark.* □□ Borrowed-source tables show constitutional ancestry, not operational identity. For complete India-versus-other-country comparison, use Comparative-Constitutional-Schemes.md.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE
Purpose: this owner carries two routed GS-II Mains demands and a cluster of political-theory Prelims demands (rule of law, constitutional government, liberty). This section supplies executable Mains routes, a "borrowed / adapted / rejected" engine, and the separation-of-powers and constitutional-morality anchors so no answer depends on Advanced.

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 7.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of 7.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

7.0.1 — 2019 GS-II Q1: "Strict separation of powers against checks and balances." *· Directive* ***Explain*** *·* ***10 marks · 150 words****. Neutral demand: contrast a strict/rigid separation of powers with the checks-and-balances model, and locate India. Executable route: Thesis: □□ India adopts* ***checks and balances****, not Montesquieu's* ***strict*** *separation — functions are broadly differentiated but deliberately overlap. Constitutional markers of separation: □* ***Art 50*** *(separate judiciary from executive — a DPSP); □* ***Arts 121 & 211*** *(no legislative discussion of a judge's conduct except on a removal motion); □* ***Arts 122 & 212*** *(courts not to inquire into parliamentary/legislative proceedings); □* ***Art 361*** *(immunity of President/Governor). Deliberate overlaps: □ executive law-making by* ***ordinance (Arts 123/213)****; delegated legislation; judicial rule-making and contempt power (quasi-legislative/judicial). Checks across organs: □ judicial review (Arts* ***13, 32, 226****); □ executive responsibility to the legislature (****Art 75****); Parliament's amending power (****Art 368****) checked by the* ***basic structure****. Case law as proposition: □ Ram Jawaya Kapur v. State of Punjab (1955) — Indian practice does* ***not*** *contemplate a rigid separation; □ Kesavananda Bharati (1973) and Indira Nehru Gandhi v. Raj Narain (1975) — separation of powers is part of the* ***basic structure****. Verdict: India rejects strict separation to reconcile* ***parliamentary government*** *(fusion of executive and legislature) with* ***judicial review****.* ***Core routing supersedes the older advanced/03_Salient-Features.md pointer for this demand. 7.0.2 — 2021 GS-II Q1: "Doctrine of Constitutional Morality and its essential facets."*** *· Directive* ***Explain with the help of illustrations*** *·* ***10 marks · 150 words****. Neutral demand: define constitutional morality and set out its essential facets with illustrations. Executable route: Definition: □□* ***Ambedkar's*** *usage (after George Grote) — a paramount reverence for constitutional* ***forms, methods and values*** *over personal, partisan or majoritarian morality. Essential facets: □□ rule of law; fidelity to constitutional procedure and institutions; protection of individual/plural rights against majoritarian sentiment; due process; accountability and self-restraint by high functionaries. Normative source: □* ***Preamble*** *values (justice, liberty, equality, fraternity, dignity) +* ***Arts 14, 15, 19, 21, 25****. Illustrations (judicial): □ Navtej Singh Johar v. Union of India (2018) and □ Indian Young Lawyers Assn. v. State of Kerala (Sabarimala, 2018) — constitutional values preferred over exclusionary social morality; □ Govt. of NCT of Delhi v. Union of India (2018) — linked to democratic accountability and federal balance. Caution: □□ criticised as judicially subjective — it must be derived from constitutional* ***text and structure****, not a judge's personal morality. Verdict: constitutional morality is the operative ethic that makes written constitutional forms effective.* ***Core routing supersedes the older advanced/03_Salient-Features.md pointer for this demand.***

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

HIGH

Foundation · 7.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Nature of Indian federalism	"federal in form, unitary in spirit", "quasi-federal"	Federal features → unitary features → "Union of States" → weighted verdict
Separation of powers / checks and balances	"strict separation", "Explain"	Strict vs checks → Arts 50/121/122/211/212/361 → overlaps → basic structure
Constitutional morality	"essential facets", "with illustrations"	Definition → facets → Preamble/FR source → 2018 cases → caution
Borrowed vs original	"bag of borrowings", Ambedkar's defence	Adapted table → rejected features → indigenous additions → verdict
Parliamentary sovereignty vs judicial review	"synthesis", "who is supreme"	Neither absolute → *Maneka Gandhi* qualification of Art 21 procedure → Art 368 vs basic structure
Secularism	"positive secularism", India vs West	No state religion → Arts 25–28 → equal respect (not a wall) → verdict

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 7.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

India follows checks and balances rather than a strict separation of powers, because a parliamentary executive is by design fused with the legislature, and it is judicial review — not organ isolation — that guards liberty.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

7.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1 India follows checks and balances rather than a strict separation of powers, because a parliamentary executive is by design fused with the legislature	**Dimension 2** Constitutional morality is not the morality of judges but the disciplined fidelity to constitutional methods and values that Ambedkar thought a young
Dimension 3 The Indian Constitution combines federal power-sharing with a strong-centre design: single citizenship, an integrated judiciary, All-India Services an	**Dimension 4** The charge that the Constitution is a "bag of borrowings" mistakes adaptation for imitation: what was borrowed was reshaped, and what was most distinc

STATIC THEORY

- Constitutional morality is not the morality of judges but the disciplined fidelity to constitutional methods and values that Ambedkar thought a young democracy could not take for granted.

- The Indian Constitution combines federal power-sharing with a strong-centre design: single citizenship, an integrated judiciary, All-India Services and emergency provisions create integration without erasing constitutionally distributed State power.

- The charge that the Constitution is a "bag of borrowings" mistakes adaptation for imitation: what was borrowed was reshaped, and what was most distinctive — universal franchise, positive secularism, a justiciable-plus-directive rights scheme — was not borrowed at all.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 7.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Direct thesis → 2–3 constitutional anchors → one counterpoint → verdict	3 units (Articles + one case)
15	Thesis → dimension 1 → dimension 2 → adapted/rejected contrast → verdict	5–6 units
20 · 250 words	Thesis → federal/unitary → separation & morality → borrowed/adapted/rejected → indigenous additions → graded verdict	6–8 units + a sources paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 7.4 Bank A — Borrowed, adapted and rejected (value-add engine)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Source	Adapted into the Constitution	Consciously rejected / altered
□ British	Parliamentary govt, rule of law, single citizenship, writs, bicameralism	**Parliamentary sovereignty** (India has judicial review) and hereditary monarchy (India is a **republic**)
□ US	Fundamental Rights, judicial review, VP, impeachment	The text chose **"procedure established by law" (Art 21)** rather than the US phrase "due process", but *Maneka Gandhi* (1978) requires procedure to be fair, just and reasonable; rigid separation and **dual citizenship** were not adopted
□ Ireland	DPSP, Rajya Sabha nomination, method of Presidential election	—
□ Canada	Strong-Centre federation, residuary powers in the Centre, Centre-appointed Governors	US-style "indestructible states" rejected in favour of a strong Centre
□ Australia	Concurrent List, joint sitting, freedom of trade	—
□ Weimar Germany	Suspension of FR during Emergency	—
□ USSR	Fundamental Duties, ideal of justice	State-socialist single-party model **not** adopted
□ Colonial reforms	Federal scheme, Governor, services, administrative detail (GoI Act 1935)	**Separate/communal electorates (1909)** rejected — single citizenship, universal franchise

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.4 Bank A — Borrowed, adapted and rejected (value-add engine)

HIGH

Foundation · 7.4 Bank A — Borrowed, adapted and rejected (value-add engine)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Analytical use:** the third column is the mark-winning move — it shows the framers **chose**, and converts a "borrowing" narration into an argument.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.4 Bank A — Borrowed, adapted and rejected (value-add engine)

HIGH

Foundation · 7.5 Bank B — Separation of powers as practised (routed anchors)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: separation exists as functional insulation, not organ isolation. **Evidence:** □ **Art 50** directs separation of the judiciary from the executive; □ **Arts 121/211** bar legislative debate on a judge's conduct except on a removal motion; □ **Arts 122/212** bar courts from inquiring into legislative proceedings; □ **Art 361** immunises the President/Governor. **Significance:** □□ these protect each organ's core function while permitting overlap. **Caution:** □ Art 50 is a **DPSP** (non-justiciable), not an enforceable command.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** overlaps are constitutional, not accidental. **Evidence:** □ executive **ordinance** power (Arts 123/213); □ Parliament's constituent power (Art 368); □ courts' contempt and rule-making powers. **Significance:** □□ the model is checks-and-balances. **Caution:** □ *Kesavananda (1973)* makes separation part of the **basic structure**, so overlap cannot become domination.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: separation exists as functional insulation, not organ isolation. **Evidence: Art 50** directs separation of the judiciary from the executive; **Arts 121/211** bar legislative debate on a judge's conduct except on a removal motion; **Arts 122/212** bar courts from inquiring into legislative proceedings; **Art 361** immunises the President/Governor. **Significance:** □□ these protect each organ's core function while permitting overlap. **Caution:** Art 50 is a **DPSP** (non-justiciable), not an enforceable command.

2. Claim: overlaps are constitutional, not accidental. **Evidence:** executive **ordinance** power (Arts 123/213); Parliament's constituent power (Art 368); courts' contempt and rule-making powers. **Significance:** □□ the model is checks-and-balances. **Caution:** *Kesavananda (1973)* makes separation part of the **basic structure**, so overlap cannot become domination.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.5 Bank B — Separation of powers as practised (routed anchors)

HIGH

Foundation · 7.6 Bank C — Constitutional morality (routed anchor)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: constitutional morality privileges constitutional values over social/majoritarian morality. **Evidence:** □ Preamble + Arts 14, 15, 19, 21, 25; □ *Navtej Johar (2018)*, *Sabarimala (2018)*, *NCT of Delhi (2018)*. **Significance:** □□ it disciplines both citizens and high functionaries and protects minorities/individuals. **Caution:** □□ it must be anchored in text and structure, not judicial preference; □ Art 50/DPSP-type values inform but do not by themselves create rights.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: constitutional morality privileges constitutional values over social/majoritarian morality. **Evidence:** Preamble + Arts 14, 15, 19, 21, 25; *Navtej Johar (2018)*, *Sabarimala (2018)*, *NCT of Delhi (2018)*. **Significance:** □□ it disciplines both citizens and high functionaries and protects minorities/individuals. **Caution:** □□ it must be anchored in text and structure, not judicial preference; Art 50/DPSP-type values inform but do not by themselves create rights.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.6 Bank C — Constitutional morality (routed anchor)

HIGH

Foundation · 7.7 Mechanism, incentives and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Strong-centre federal mechanism:** single citizenship, integrated judiciary, All-India Services and Arts 352–360 permit constitutionally specified centralisation in crisis without dissolving the federal Constitution — useful for emergency coordination but prone to central overreach (the Art 356 debate).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.7 MECHANISM, INCENTIVES AND CONSEQUENCES: RECALL MAP

7.7 Mechanism, incentives and consequences

V

Dimension 1 □□ Strong-centre federal mechanism: single citizenship, integrated judiciary, All-India Services and Arts 352–360 permit constitutionally specified ce	**Dimension 2** □□ Checks-and-balances incentive: fusion of executive and legislature concentrates power in the majority party, so judicial review and the basic-struc
Dimension 3 □□ Who gains, who loses: the design privileges the ruling majority in ordinary times and the Centre in emergencies; the individual and the minority de	

STATIC THEORY

- □□ **Checks-and-balances incentive:** fusion of executive and legislature concentrates power in the majority party, so **judicial review** and the **basic-structure** limit become the principal external check.

- □□ **Who gains, who loses:** the design privileges the ruling majority in ordinary times and the Centre in emergencies; the individual and the minority depend on **judicial review** and the basic-structure limit for protection.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.7 Mechanism, incentives and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 7.8 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 "Bag of borrowings": Ambedkar's reply — after a century of written constitutions all must resemble one another in fundamentals; the only novelty lies in adaptation, so the charge "is based on inadequate study."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.8 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT AND VARIATION: RECALL MAP

7.8 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

V

Dimension 1 "Bag of borrowings": Ambedkar's reply — after a century of written constitutions all must resemble one another in fundamentals; the only novelty lie	**Dimension 2** Federal variation: the "unitary bias" bites unevenly — it is felt most in Art 356 / Governor practice and least where cooperative institutions (GST
Dimension 3 Counter-argument on secularism: critics of "positive secularism" argue that state engagement with religion invites majoritarian capture; defenders	

STATIC THEORY

- **Federal variation:** the "unitary bias" bites unevenly — it is felt most in **Art 356 / Governor** practice and least where cooperative institutions (**GST Council, Finance Commission**) share power.

- **Counter-argument on secularism:** critics of "positive secularism" argue that state engagement with religion invites majoritarian capture; defenders reply that **equal respect**, not a wall of separation, suits India's plural society.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. "Bag of borrowings": Ambedkar's reply — after a century of written constitutions all must resemble one another in fundamentals; the only novelty lies in adaptation, so the charge "is based on inadequate study."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.8 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

HIGH

Foundation · 7.9 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Separation-of-powers verdict: "India does not divide power to paralyse government; it balances power so that a fused parliamentary executive remains answerable to courts and to the Constitution's basic structure."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.9 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

7.9 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Separation-of-powers verdict: "India does not divide power to paralyse government; it balances power so that a fused parliamentary executive remains a	**Dimension 2** Constitutional-morality verdict: "Constitutional morality is what keeps constitutional forms from becoming empty forms — a reverence for method and va
Dimension 3 Federalism verdict: "The Constitution is federal enough to accommodate diversity and unitary enough to survive crisis; the balance, not either pole, i	

STATIC THEORY

- **Constitutional-morality verdict:** "Constitutional morality is what keeps constitutional forms from becoming empty forms — a reverence for method and value that the Court has used to protect the individual against the crowd."

- **Federalism verdict:** "The Constitution is federal enough to accommodate diversity and unitary enough to survive crisis; the balance, not either pole, is its design."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.9 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 7.10 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed objective demands)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of 7.10 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed objective demands).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Routed 2024 Q74 — Constitution Parts: □ ***Part IX-A = Municipalities***; □ ***Part XVIII = Emergency Provisions (Arts 352–360)***; □ ***Part XX = Amendment of the Constitution (Art 368)***. *(Panchayats = Part IX; Union Territories = Part VIII.)* ***Routed 2018 Q45 — Rule of Law:*** □ *exact official-paper answer* ***C (1, 2 and 4 only)*** *— limitation of powers, equality before law, and liberty/civil rights. "People's responsibility to the Government" is not a defining limb.* ***Routed 2018 Q40 — law and liberty:*** □ *exact official-paper answer* ***B — "If there are no laws, there is no liberty."*** *Ordered liberty depends on general, constitutionally limited law; this does not mean that every law enlarges liberty.* ***Routed 2020 Q7 & 2021 Q94 — constitutional government:*** □□ *a* ***constitutional (limited) government*** *is one whose powers are* ***defined and limited by a constitution*** *and subject to checks (rule of law, judicial review), as against arbitrary or unlimited government.* ***Cross-owned 2021 Q86 — federal character:*** □ *exact official-paper answer* ***A — safeguarded independence of the judiciary****; federal competence requires an independent constitutional umpire. Primary owner: Federal System.* ***Routed 2023 Q33 — chief purpose of a Constitution:*** □□ *to* ***constitute and limit*** *governmental power — distribute authority among organs and protect citizens' rights — rather than merely to organise administration.* ***Routed 2021 Q87 — definition of "State" (political science):*** □□ *the four elements —* ***population, territory, government and sovereignty****.* ***Cross-owned 2021 Q89 — single citizenship:*** □ *exact official-paper answer* ***A (statement 1 only)****. India has one citizenship and one domicile in the question's formulation; the other statements use false absolutes. Primary owner: Citizenship.* ***Routed 2021 Q90 — best safeguard of liberty in a liberal democracy:*** □ *exact official-paper answer* ***D — separation of powers****. A "committed judiciary" is not synonymous with an independent judiciary.* ***Routed 2023 Q84 — National Flag / Flag Code:*** □ *answer* ***D — Statement I is incorrect but Statement II is correct****. The Flag Code's nine standard sizes do* ***not*** *include 600 mm × 400 mm, although the prescribed ratio is 3:2.* ***Standard traps:*** □ *Art 1 =* ***"Union of States"*** *("Federation" never used);* □ *Art 21 =* ***"procedure established by law"****, not "due process";* □ *"socialist/secular" added by the* ***42nd Amendment, 1976****;* □ *voting age lowered* ***21 → 18*** *by the* ***61st Amendment, 1988****.*

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.10 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed objective demands)

HIGH

Foundation · 7.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

Do **not** say the Constitution uses the word **"Federation"** — □ Art 1 says **"Union of States."** Do **not** mechanically equate the wording of Art 21 with narrow review — □ the text says **"procedure established by law"**, while *Maneka Gandhi* requires the procedure to be fair, just and reasonable. Do **not** say India follows a **strict** separation of powers — □ it follows **checks and balances**.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Do **not** present "socialist/secular/integrity" as original Preamble words — □ added by the **42nd Amendment, 1976**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.11 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

7.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 Do not present "socialist/secular/integrity" as original Preamble words — □ added by the 42nd Amendment, 1976.	**Dimension 2** Do not describe constitutional morality as a judge's personal morality — □ it is derived from constitutional text and structure.
Dimension 3 Do not claim a blanket ban on judges' post-retirement work — □ Article 124(7) bars retired Supreme Court judges from pleading or acting before any cou	**Dimension 4** Do not homogenise constitutional bodies — □ the Election Commission, CAG, Public Service Commissions and Finance Commission have different appointment

STATIC THEORY

- Do **not** describe constitutional morality as a judge's personal morality — □ it is derived from constitutional text and structure.

- Do **not** claim a blanket ban on judges' post-retirement work — □ Article 124(7) bars retired Supreme Court judges from pleading or acting before any court or authority in India, while Article 220 permits retired permanent High Court judges to practise only before the Supreme Court and other High Courts.

- Do **not** homogenise constitutional bodies — □ the Election Commission, CAG, Public Service Commissions and Finance Commission have different appointment, tenure, removal, expenditure and reporting designs; charged expenditure is not a generic safeguard for all.

- Do **not** call crisis centralisation or a constitutional third tier globally unique — □ state India's specific Articles 352/356/360 design and Parts IX/IX-A architecture instead.

- Do **not** say single citizenship eliminates every State-linked distinction — □ constitutionally or legally permitted residence, domicile and local qualifications can still matter in specified contexts.

- □ **Co-operative societies:** *Union of India v. Rajendra N. Shah* (20 July 2021) invalidated Part IX-B insofar as it governed State co-operative societies without State ratification; the multi-State portion survived. Source checked **28 August 2026**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Do **not** present "socialist/secular/integrity" as original Preamble words — added by the **42nd Amendment, 1976**.

2. Do **not** describe constitutional morality as a judge's personal morality — it is derived from constitutional text and structure.

3. Do **not** claim a blanket ban on judges' post-retirement work — Article 124(7) bars retired Supreme Court judges from pleading or acting before any court or authority in India, while Article 220 permits retired permanent High Court judges to practise only before the Supreme Court and other High Courts.

4. Do **not** homogenise constitutional bodies — the Election Commission, CAG, Public Service Commissions and Finance Commission have different appointment, tenure, removal, expenditure and reporting designs; charged expenditure is not a generic safeguard for all.

5. Do **not** call crisis centralisation or a constitutional third tier globally unique — state India's specific Articles 352/356/360 design and Parts IX/IX-A architecture instead.

6. Do **not** say single citizenship eliminates every State-linked distinction — constitutionally or legally permitted residence, domicile and local qualifications can still matter in specified contexts.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · 7.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 J&K / Art 370: the Supreme Court upheld the application of the whole Constitution through the 2019 measures in December 2023 (*In re Article 370*), treated Article 370 as temporary and recorded the Union's statehood assurance. No official restoration notification was located by **28 August 2026**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **National Flag:** the Flag Code lists 6300×4200, 3600×2400, 2700×1800, 1800×1200, 1350×900, 900×600, 450×300, 225×150 and 150×100 mm; **600×400 mm is not a standard size**. Ratio alone does not establish notified status.

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. National Flag: the Flag Code lists 6300×4200, 3600×2400, 2700×1800, 1800×1200, 1350×900, 900×600, 450×300, 225×150 and 150×100 mm; **600×400 mm is not a standard size**. Ratio alone does not establish notified status.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	74	Constitution Parts (Municipalities IX-A, Emergency XVIII, amendment XX)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md.* ***Answer-key rule:*** *The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.* ***Years represented:*** *2024* ***Paper(s):*** *Prelims GS-I* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Constitution Parts (Municipalities IX-A, Emergency XVIII, amendment XX)

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 Constitution Parts (Municipalities IX-A, Emergency XVIII, amendment XX)	**Dimension 2** This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -⟶	**Dimension 4** less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -⟶

STATIC THEORY

- This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -⟶

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -⟶

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	40	Conceptual relationship between law and liberty	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	45	Rule of Law main features and principles	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	7	Constitutional government definition as limited government	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	87	Definition of State in political science theory	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	90	Best safeguard of liberty in liberal democracy	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	94	Constitutional government definition and limiting authority	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	33	Chief purpose of a Constitution in governance	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	Prelims GS-I	84	National Flag India Flag Code standard sizes and proportions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Foundation · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.* ***Answer-key rule:*** *The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.* ***Years represented:*** *2018, 2020, 2021, 2023* ***Paper(s):*** *Prelims GS-I* ***Routed question demands:*** *8*

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Conceptual relationship between law and liberty

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 Conceptual relationship between law and liberty	**Dimension 2** Rule of Law main features and principles
Dimension 3 Constitutional government definition as limited government	**Dimension 4** Definition of State in political science theory

STATIC THEORY

- Rule of Law main features and principles
- Constitutional government definition as limited government
- Definition of State in political science theory
- Best safeguard of liberty in liberal democracy
- Constitutional government definition and limiting authority
- Chief purpose of a Constitution in governance

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

National Flag India Flag Code standard sizes and proportions

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.
- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Official syllabus/index and owned core: *written and detailed Constitution; constitutional supremacy; mixed amendment procedure; federal division with a strong Centre; parliamentary government; independent integrated judiciary; rights, DPSP and duties; secular republic; universal adult suffrage; single citizenship; constitutional bodies; emergencies; local government and co-operative societies.* ***Exact text map:*** *Article 1 and Part I; Articles 13, 32 and 226 review; Articles 50, 121-122, 211-212 and 361 functional separation; Article 75 collective responsibility; Article 368 amendment; Parts IX/IX-A/IX-B; Part XVIII and Part XX; Seventh, Tenth, Eleventh and Twelfth Schedules.* ***Amendment chronology:*** *42nd Amendment 1976 added Socialist, Secular and Integrity and is the 'Mini-Constitution'; 61st Amendment 1988 lowered voting age to 18; 73rd/74th Amendments 1992 constitutionalised local government; the 97th Amendment's State-co-operative portion was invalidated in Union of India v. Rajendra N. Shah (20 July 2021) for lack of ratification.* ***Doctrine/cases:*** *Ram Jawaya (1955) rejects rigid separation; Kesavananda Bharati (1973) and Indira Nehru Gandhi (1975) protect structural limits; Maneka Gandhi (1978) makes Article 21 procedure fair, just and reasonable; constitutional morality must remain anchored in text/structure.* ***Institutional mechanism:*** *distinguish legislative-executive fusion, judicial review, cabinet responsibility, federal lists/residuary power, independent constitutional bodies, emergency centralisation and third-tier devolution; formal design does not prove effective independence or devolution.* ***Cross-owner boundary:*** *Federal System, Parliamentary System, Fundamental Rights, Emergency Provisions, local-government and co-operative topics own detailed doctrine; this owner supplies the integrating architecture and exact close-option distinctions.* ***Four-ledger hostile audit:*** *syllabus, prerequisites, standard feature taxonomy and 2018-2026 PYQs were searched for missing doctrines, Parts, Schedules, amendments, cases, exceptions and implementation qualifications.* ***Verified PYQ ownership, 2018-2026:*** *direct routes include 2018 Q40/Q45, 2019 GS-II Q1, 2020 Q7, 2021 Q90/Q94 and GS-II Q1, 2023 Q33/Q84, and 2024 Q74; federal character and single citizenship remain disclosed cross-owner routes. No 2025/2026 direct route is invented.* ***Current legal status:*** *In re Article 370 (11 December 2023) upheld the 2019 constitutional measures and recorded that restoration of J&K statehood should occur at the earliest; absent an official statehood notification, restoration is not reported as completed.*

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 3 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference. (Very high-frequency Prelims chapter.)	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/Salient-Features.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 3 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference. *(Very high-frequency Prelims chapter.)*

- *Companion: basic/Salient-Features.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference. *(Very high-frequency Prelims chapter.)*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · Framing

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Borrowed from almost every constitution yet distinctive. Major amendments reshaping original 1949 features: **7th, 42nd, 44th, 73rd, 74th, 97th, 101st**. □ **42nd Amendment (1976) = "Mini- Constitution."** But *Kesavananda* (1973) bars altering **basic structure**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Borrowed from almost every constitution yet distinctive. Major amendments reshaping original 1949 features: **7th, 42nd, 44th, 73rd, 74th, 97th, 101st**. **42nd Amendment (1976) = "Mini- Constitution."** But *Kesavananda* (1973) bars altering **basic structure**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Framing

HIGH

Advanced · The 17 Salient Features

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of The 17 Salient Features.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → The 17 Salient Features

HIGH

Advanced · Lengthiest written constitution □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Original (1949):** Preamble + **395 Articles** (22 Parts) + **8 Schedules**. **Present (2019):** Preamble + **~470 Articles** (25 Parts) + **12 Schedules**. Amendments **deleted ~20 Articles + Part VII**, **added ~95 Articles, 4 Parts (IV-A, IX-A, IX-B, XIV-A), 4 Schedules (9,10,11,12)**. Four causes of size: (a) geographical vastness/diversity; (b) **GoI Act 1935** influence; (c) **single constitution for Centre & states**; (d) legal luminaries' dominance.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Original (1949): Preamble + **395 Articles** (22 Parts) + **8 Schedules**. **Present (2019):** Preamble + **~470 Articles** (25 Parts) + **12 Schedules**. Amendments **deleted ~20 Articles + Part VII**, **added ~95 Articles, 4 Parts (IV-A, IX-A, IX-B, XIV-A), 4 Schedules (9,10,11,12)**. Four causes of size: (a) geographical vastness/diversity; (b) **GoI Act 1935** influence; (c) **single constitution for Centre & states**; (d) legal luminaries' dominance.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Lengthiest written constitution □

HIGH

Advanced · Drawn from various sources □□

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Ambedkar: framed after **"ransacking all the known Constitutions of the World." Structural** part ← **GoI Act 1935**; **philosophical** part ← **US (FR)** + **Ireland (DPSP)**; **political** part ← **British** (Cabinet govt, executive-legislature relations). **GoI Act 1935 = most profound/material source** (greater than half the provisions resemble it). *(Full sources table below — §Sources.)*

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Ambedkar: framed after "**ransacking all the known Constitutions of the World**." **Structural** part ← **GoI Act 1935**; **philosophical** part ← **US (FR)** + **Ireland (DPSP)**; **political** part ← **British** (Cabinet govt, executive-legislature relations). **GoI Act 1935 = most profound/material source** (greater than half the provisions resemble it). *(Full sources table below — §Sources.)*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Drawn from various sources □□

HIGH

Advanced · Blend of rigidity & flexibility

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Neither rigid (USA) nor flexible (Britain). **Art 368:** (a) special majority; (b) special majority

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- half states; plus (c) simple-majority items **outside Art 368**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Neither rigid (USA) nor flexible (Britain). **Art 368:** (a) special majority; (b) special majority

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Blend of rigidity & flexibility

HIGH

Advanced · Federal system with unitary bias □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Federal features:** two governments, division of powers, written & supreme constitution, rigidity, independent judiciary, bicameralism. □ **Unitary features:** strong Centre, single constitution, single citizenship, flexibility, integrated judiciary, Centre-appointed governors, all-India services, emergency provisions. □ Word "Federation" **never used**; **Art 1 = "Union of States"** → (i) not an agreement of states, (ii) **no right to secede**. Descriptions: **"quasi-federal" (K.C. Wheare)**, "bargaining federalism" (Morris Jones), **"co-operative federalism" (Granville Austin)**, "federation with a centralising tendency" (Ivor Jennings).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Federal features: two governments, division of powers, written & supreme constitution, rigidity, independent judiciary, bicameralism. **Unitary features:** strong Centre, single constitution, single citizenship, flexibility, integrated judiciary, Centre-appointed governors, all-India services, emergency provisions. Word "Federation" **never used**; **Art 1 = "Union of States"** → (i) not an agreement of states, (ii) **no right to secede**. Descriptions: **"quasi-federal" (K.C. Wheare)**, "bargaining federalism" (Morris Jones), **"co-operative federalism" (Granville Austin)**, "federation with a centralising tendency" (Ivor Jennings).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Federal system with unitary bias □

HIGH

Advanced · Parliamentary form of government □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ British (Westminster) model, not US presidential — cooperation between legislature & executive (vs separation of powers). At **Centre & states**. Features: (a) nominal + real executives; (b) majority- party rule; (c) **collective responsibility** to legislature; (d) ministers from legislature; (e) PM/ CM leadership; (f) dissolution of lower House. □ Differs from Britain: Indian Parliament is **not sovereign**; India has an **elected head (republic)** vs hereditary monarch.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. British (Westminster) model, not US presidential — cooperation between legislature & executive (vs separation of powers). At **Centre & states**. Features: (a) nominal + real executives; (b) majority- party rule; (c) **collective responsibility** to legislature; (d) ministers from legislature; (e) PM/ CM leadership; (f) dissolution of lower House. Differs from Britain: Indian Parliament is **not sovereign**; India has an **elected head (republic)** vs hereditary monarch.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Parliamentary form of government □

HIGH

Advanced · Synthesis of parliamentary government & judicial review

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Blends **British parliamentary government** with American-influenced **judicial review**, but neither Parliament nor the judiciary is legally sovereign over the Constitution. The older textbook contrast between Indian "procedure established by law" and American "due process" requires qualification after *Maneka Gandhi* (1978), which requires Article 21 procedure to be fair, just and reasonable. Courts can strike down laws; Parliament can amend most of the Constitution subject to basic structure.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Blends **British parliamentary government** with American-influenced **judicial review**, but neither Parliament nor the judiciary is legally sovereign over the Constitution. The older textbook contrast between Indian "procedure established by law" and American "due process" requires qualification after *Maneka Gandhi* (1978), which requires Article 21 procedure to be fair, just and reasonable. Courts can strike down laws; Parliament can amend most of the Constitution subject to basic structure.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Synthesis of parliamentary government & judicial review

HIGH

Advanced · Integrated & independent judiciary □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Integrated:** single pyramid — SC → High Courts → subordinate courts — enforcing **both central & state laws** (unlike US dual system). SC = federal court + highest appeal court + guarantor of FR + guardian of Constitution. **Independence safeguards:** security of tenure, protected service conditions, charged expenditure, restrictions on legislative discussion of judges' conduct, constitutional removal, contempt power and separation from the executive. Post-retirement practice restrictions differ: Article 124(7) bars retired Supreme Court judges from pleading or acting before any court or authority in India; Article 220 permits retired permanent High Court judges to practise only before the Supreme Court and other High Courts. These are not a blanket ban on all public assignments.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Integrated: single pyramid — SC → High Courts → subordinate courts — enforcing **both central & state laws** (unlike US dual system). SC = federal court + highest appeal court + guarantor of FR + guardian of Constitution. **Independence safeguards:** security of tenure, protected service conditions, charged expenditure, restrictions on legislative discussion of judges' conduct, constitutional removal, contempt power and separation from the executive. Post-retirement practice restrictions differ: Article 124(7) bars retired Supreme Court judges from pleading or acting before any court or authority in India; Article 220 permits retired permanent High Court judges to practise only before the Supreme Court and other High Courts. These are not a blanket ban on all public assignments.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Integrated & independent judiciary □

HIGH

Advanced · Fundamental Rights

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Part III, **6 rights** (14–18, 19–22, 23–24, 25–28, 29–30, 32) — promote **political democracy**, justiciable via writs; not absolute (reasonable restrictions); amendable; suspendable in emergency **except Art 20 & 21**. *(Detail: 07_Fundamental-Rights.md.)*

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Part III, **6 rights** (14–18, 19–22, 23–24, 25–28, 29–30, 32) — promote **political democracy**, justiciable via writs; not absolute (reasonable restrictions); amendable; suspendable in emergency **except Art 20 & 21**. *(Detail: 07_Fundamental-Rights.md.)*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Fundamental Rights

HIGH

Advanced · Directive Principles of State Policy

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Part IV, Ambedkar's "novel feature"; 3 categories; **social & economic democracy / welfare state**; non-justiciable; Minerva Mills — FR-DPSP **balance = bedrock**. *(Detail: 08_Directive-Principles.md.)*

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Part IV, Ambedkar's "novel feature"; 3 categories; **social & economic democracy / welfare state**; non-justiciable; Minerva Mills — FR-DPSP **balance = bedrock**. *(Detail: 08_Directive-Principles.md.)*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Directive Principles of State Policy

HIGH

Advanced · Fundamental Duties

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Part IV-A, **Art 51A**, **11 duties** (42nd Amdt 1976 + 86th Amdt 2002), Swaran Singh Committee, citizens only, non-justiciable. *(Detail: 09_Fundamental-Duties.md.)*

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Part IV-A, **Art 51A**, **11 duties** (42nd Amdt 1976 + 86th Amdt 2002), Swaran Singh Committee, citizens only, non-justiciable. *(Detail: 09_Fundamental-Duties.md.)*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Fundamental Duties

HIGH

Advanced · A secular state □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ No official religion. "**Secular**" added to Preamble by **42nd Amdt 1976**. Provisions: Art 14, 15, 16, 25–30, 44. □ India = **positive secularism** (equal respect / equal protection to all religions), not a strict Western **negative** wall-of-separation. The Constitution rejects separate electorates and religious discrimination in political citizenship; SC/ST legislative reservations are remedial representation, not an exception to an otherwise "abolished communal representation" rule.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. No official religion. "**Secular**" added to Preamble by **42nd Amdt 1976**. Provisions: Art 14, 15, 16, 25–30, 44. India = **positive secularism** (equal respect / equal protection to all religions), not a strict Western **negative** wall-of-separation. The Constitution rejects separate electorates and religious discrimination in political citizenship; SC/ST legislative reservations are remedial representation, not an exception to an otherwise "abolished communal representation" rule.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → A secular state □

HIGH

Advanced · Universal adult franchise □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Vote at **18** (reduced from 21 by **61st Amdt, 1988**) for Lok Sabha & state assemblies, no discrimination. A bold experiment given size/poverty/illiteracy.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Vote at **18** (reduced from 21 by **61st Amdt, 1988**) for Lok Sabha & state assemblies, no discrimination. A bold experiment given size/poverty/illiteracy.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Universal adult franchise □

HIGH

Advanced · Single citizenship

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Dual polity but **single (Indian) citizenship** — unlike US dual citizenship. It supports common national membership, while constitutionally or legally permitted residence, domicile and local qualifications can still matter in specified contexts. *(Detail: 06_Citizenship.md.)*

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Dual polity but **single (Indian) citizenship** — unlike US dual citizenship. It supports common national membership, while constitutionally or legally permitted residence, domicile and local qualifications can still matter in specified contexts. *(Detail: 06_Citizenship.md.)*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Single citizenship

HIGH

Advanced · Independent bodies □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ (a) **Election Commission** (Art 324); (b) **CAG** — "guardian of public purse"; (c) **UPSC**; (d) **State PSCs**; and (e) the periodically constituted **Finance Commission** (Art 280). Their safeguards must be stated body by body: tenure/removal, service conditions, charged expenditure and reporting rules are not identical, and charged expenditure is not a generic safeguard for every body.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. (a) **Election Commission** (Art 324); (b) **CAG** — "guardian of public purse"; (c) **UPSC**; (d) **State PSCs**; and (e) the periodically constituted **Finance Commission** (Art 280). Their safeguards must be stated body by body: tenure/removal, service conditions, charged expenditure and reporting rules are not identical, and charged expenditure is not a generic safeguard for every body.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Independent bodies □

HIGH

Advanced · Emergency provisions □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Three types: (a) **National Emergency** — war/external aggression/armed rebellion (**Art 352**); (b) **President's Rule** — failure of constitutional machinery (**Art 356**), with Article 365 relevant where non-compliance with Union directions supports the President's constitutional satisfaction; (c) **Financial Emergency** (**Art 360**). These provisions can produce temporary centralisation within the Constitution. Crisis centralisation is not globally unique; India's examinable distinction is its own three-part design and post-1975 safeguards.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Three types: (a) **National Emergency** — war/external aggression/armed rebellion (**Art 352**); (b) **President's Rule** — failure of constitutional machinery (**Art 356**), with Article 365 relevant where non-compliance with Union directions supports the President's constitutional satisfaction; (c) **Financial Emergency** (**Art 360**). These provisions can produce temporary centralisation within the Constitution. Crisis centralisation is not globally unique; India's examinable distinction is its own three-part design and post-1975 safeguards.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Emergency provisions □

HIGH

Advanced · Three-tier government □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **73rd Amdt 1992** → **Panchayats** (Part IX + 11th Schedule); **74th Amdt 1992** → **Municipalities** (Part IX-A + 12th Schedule). Local government exists in other constitutional systems; India's distinctive point is the detailed constitutional status given to both rural and urban local government.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 73rd Amdt 1992 → Panchayats (Part IX + 11th Schedule); **74th Amdt 1992 → Municipalities** (Part IX-A + 12th Schedule). Local government exists in other constitutional systems; India's distinctive point is the detailed constitutional status given to both rural and urban local government.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Three-tier government □

HIGH

Advanced · Co-operative societies

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **97th Amdt 2011:** (1) right to form co-ops = FR under **Art 19**; (2) new DPSP **Art 43-B**; (3) new **Part IX-B** (Art 243-ZH to 243-ZT). □□ (SC in *Union of India v. Rajendra N. Shah*, 2021, struck down the Part IX-B provisions **for state co-ops** for lack of state ratification; multi-state co-op provisions stand.)

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 97th Amdt 2011: (1) right to form co-ops = FR under **Art 19**; (2) new DPSP **Art 43-B**; (3) new **Part IX-B** (Art 243-ZH to 243-ZT). □□ (SC in *Union of India v. Rajendra N. Shah*, 2021, struck down the Part IX-B provisions **for state co-ops** for lack of state ratification; multi-state co-op provisions stand.)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Co-operative societies

HIGH

Advanced · Sources of the Constitution — full table (Table 3.4) □□ Prelims gold · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Source	Features borrowed
□ **GoI Act 1935**	Federal scheme, office of Governor, judiciary, PSCs, emergency provisions, administrative details
□ **British**	Parliamentary govt, rule of law, legislative procedure, single citizenship, cabinet system, prerogative writs, parliamentary privileges, **bicameralism**
□ **US**	Fundamental rights, independence of judiciary, judicial review, impeachment of President, removal of SC/HC judges, **post of Vice-President**
□ **Ireland**	DPSP, **nomination of members to Rajya Sabha**, method of election of President
□ **Canada**	Federation with strong Centre, residuary powers in Centre, Centre-appointed governors, **advisory jurisdiction of SC**
□ **Australia**	**Concurrent List**, freedom of trade/commerce/intercourse, **joint sitting** of the two Houses
□ **Weimar (Germany)**	**Suspension of FR during Emergency**
□ **USSR (Soviet)**	**Fundamental Duties**, ideal of justice (social/economic/political) in Preamble

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Sources of the Constitution — full table (Table 3.4) □□ Prelims gold

HIGH

Advanced · Sources of the Constitution — full table (Table 3.4) □□ Prelims gold · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Source	Features borrowed
□ **France**	**Republic**, ideals of liberty/equality/fraternity in Preamble
□ **South Africa**	**Procedure for amendment**, election of Rajya Sabha members
□ **Japan**	**Procedure established by law**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Sources of the Constitution — full table (Table 3.4) □□ Prelims gold

HIGH

Advanced · Criticism

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **"Borrowed/bag of borrowings/hotch-potch/patchwork."** Ambedkar's rebuttal: after 100+ years of written constitutions, all must look similar in fundamentals; the only novelty is variation to suit Indian needs — "the charge of a blind copy is based on inadequate study."

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **"Borrowed/bag of borrowings/hotch-potch/patchwork."** Ambedkar's rebuttal: after 100+ years of written constitutions, all must look similar in fundamentals; the only novelty is variation to suit Indian needs — "the charge of a blind copy is based on inadequate study."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Criticism

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA / relevance

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ J&K [SOURCE CHECKED 2026-08-28]: until 2019 J&K operated under its **own constitution** within

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

□ CA / RELEVANCE: RECALL MAP

□ CA / relevance

V

Dimension 1 □ J&K [SOURCE CHECKED 2026-08-28]: until 2019 J&K operated under its own constitution within	**Dimension 2** Article 370's asymmetrical arrangement. In December 2023 the Supreme Court upheld the application of the whole Constitution through the 2019 measures,
Dimension 3 □ Co-operatives (feature 17): Rajendra N. Shah 2021 ruling + creation of the Ministry of	**Dimension 4** Co-operation (2021) are live CA hooks.

STATIC THEORY

- Article 370's asymmetrical arrangement. In December 2023 the Supreme Court upheld the application of the whole Constitution through the 2019 measures, treated Article 370 as temporary and recorded the Union's assurance on restoration of statehood. No official restoration notification was located by the access date.

- □ Co-operatives (feature 17): *Rajendra N. Shah* 2021 ruling + creation of the **Ministry of

- Co-operation (2021)** are live CA hooks.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA / relevance

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: "Federation" is used in the Constitution

CORRECT: never; Art 1 says **"Union of States."**

WRONG: Concurrent List borrowed from Canada

CORRECT: Australia; strong-Centre federalism ← **Canada**.

WRONG: Fundamental Duties from USA

CORRECT: USSR; DPSP from USA → **Ireland** (FR ← USA).

WRONG: "Procedure established by law" from Britain

CORRECT: Japan.

WRONG: Amendment procedure borrowed from USA

CORRECT: South Africa.

WRONG: Voting age was always 18

CORRECT: reduced from **21 → 18 by 61st Amdt (1988)**.

WRONG: Secular/Socialist were original Preamble words

CORRECT: added by 42nd Amdt, 1976.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"The Indian Constitution is federal in form but unitary in spirit." Discuss. Positive secularism vs the Western wall-of-separation model. Is the Indian Constitution merely a "bag of borrowings"? (Ambedkar's defence). less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -->

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-II	1	Strict separation of powers against checks and balances	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2021	GS-II	1	Doctrine of Constitutional Morality and its essential facets	Explain with the help of illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.* ***Years represented:*** *2019, 2021* ***Paper(s):*** *GS-II* ***Routed question demands:*** *2*

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Strict separation of powers against checks and balances

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 Strict separation of powers against checks and balances	**Dimension 2** Doctrine of Constitutional Morality and its essential facets
Dimension 3 The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not cl	**Dimension 4** less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

STATIC THEORY

- Doctrine of Constitutional Morality and its essential facets

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Salient Features of the Constitution — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI